

Maria Silva

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LLB and LLM graduate with a year of practical experience at BCLP, including six months supporting a busy Real Estate Disputes team with document management, hearing bundles, court filings and deadline tracking across multiple concurrent matters. Further experience managing case files and client correspondence at Citizens Advice and in a commercial legal internship at Adobe. Familiar with iManage, electronic bundling and court filing portals. Organised, deadline-focused and comfortable handling large volumes of confidential documents.

EDUCATION

Comparative and International Dispute Resolution LLM — Merit **Sept 2024 – Oct 2025**

Queen Mary University of London

- Modules in dispute resolution, procedural issues, legal research and evidence analysis
- Transnational Law and Governance Applied module — 75%
- Dissertation on data protection and GDPR development across jurisdictions

Law LLB — 2:1 **Sept 2020 – June 2024**

University College London

- Modules included Commercial Law, Company Law, Advanced Contract Law and Alternative Dispute Resolution

International Foundation Programme in Law and International Relations **Sept 2019 – June 2020**

King's College London

- Awarded the Leaders of Tomorrow prize (top 20 of 200-student cohort; partial funding toward undergraduate degree)

EXPERIENCE

Bryan Cave Leighton Paisner LLP (BCLP) · London **Feb 2024 – Aug 2024**

Legal Placement Student — Real Estate Disputes

- Prepared electronic hearing bundles and assisted with skeleton arguments and court materials for property matters including rights of light, easements, leasehold disputes and landlord and tenant cases
- Maintained matter records on iManage across multiple concurrent files; handled court filings, hearing arrangements, matter opening and closure
- Tracked deadlines and managed large volumes of confidential documents across competing instructions
- Conducted legal and factual research; prepared client notes and cost comparisons
- Received feedback from a partner and associate that performance was comparable to a newly qualified solicitor

Bryan Cave Leighton Paisner LLP (BCLP) · London **Aug 2023 – Feb 2024**

Legal Placement Student — International Arbitration

- Supported a complex investment arbitration: reviewed and organised evidence for procedural submissions and the Claimant's memorial
- Drafted procedural orders and procedural histories; amended sections of the memorial; conducted legal research
- Became the only junior supporting the team shortly before a significant deadline, coordinating documents and tracking outstanding actions to ensure on-time submission
- Maintained structured electronic case files and monitored procedural deadlines
- Liaised with the client on required documents; coordinated external Romanian translations

Citizens Advice East Berkshire · Maidenhead **Legal Adviser**

July 2026 – Present

- Manages matters from initial instruction through to submission: drafts correspondence, prepares document schedules and applications, maintains confidential case records and meets deadlines
- Interviews clients across housing, welfare, employment, debt and family matters; takes detailed factual statements and establishes chronologies
- Advises clients on procedural requirements and translates complex rules into clear, practical guidance

Q-Legal · Remote

Oct 2024 – Jan 2025

Legal Adviser

- Managed a data-privacy matter from client instruction through to a formal written advice letter under a qualified solicitor's supervision
- Researched UK GDPR and Data Protection Act 2018 obligations; identified compliance risks and recommended practical mitigations
- Coordinated with the client and supervising solicitor to meet the submission deadline

Adobe · London

June 2022 – Aug 2022

Legal Intern

- Reviewed and amended software licensing agreements; identified contractual risks and assessed alignment with internal legal requirements
- Reviewed data-processing and confidentiality provisions; researched UK GDPR, EU GDPR and cross-border transfer requirements
- Liaised with sales, legal and international business teams to resolve contractual queries; communicated amendments to stakeholders
- Prepared and delivered an internal presentation on breach-of-contract risks and mitigation measures

SKILLS

Languages: Portuguese (native), English (fluent), Spanish (basic)

Technical skills: iManage; Microsoft Word, Excel and PowerPoint; electronic court filing portals; electronic bundling; legal research databases; document review; case management and time-recording systems

Case and evidence management: Hearing bundle preparation, court filings, procedural histories, case-file organisation, deadline tracking across multiple concurrent matters